

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Legal Assistant and New Client Advisor role in the Personal Injury team at Hodge Jones & Allen. What draws me to this particular position is its focus on client intake and screening, which sits at the heart of how a firm like HJA actually serves people at a vulnerable point in their lives. My background in client-facing legal advice, combined with direct experience of interviewing clients across sensitive matters, makes this a role I can contribute to from day one.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I have been the first point of contact for clients dealing with welfare, housing, debt and employment problems. Taking a full factual account, identifying the legal issues that matter and explaining procedural options in plain terms is the core of that work. Many of the people I see are distressed or confused, and getting the initial interview right, so that nothing important is missed and the client feels heard, is something I have had to develop deliberately. That skill maps directly onto what this role asks for: screening calls professionally, gathering accurate information and directing clients appropriately.

At BCLP, I supported a team handling complex investment arbitration, where I was liaising directly with the client to obtain required documents and coordinating with external translators under time pressure. That gave me a different kind of client communication experience, one where accuracy and clear follow-through mattered because any gap in information had procedural consequences. I also managed document schedules and tracked deadlines across several matters simultaneously, which is the kind of organised, deadline-conscious approach a busy intake function requires.

Hodge Jones and Allen's reputation for access to justice and claimant-side work is a genuine reason I want to be here rather than at a general commercial firm. The Personal Injury team's work sits squarely within the public-facing, people-first legal practice I have been building experience in, and I want to develop further in that direction. This role is a practical next step in that, not a stopgap.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva